QUANG MINH NGUYEN

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Keywords: Sustainable Finance, Empirical Asset Pricing, Climate and Biodiversity Risk Frameworks, ESG.

Education

PhD in Finance, University of St. Andrews, Scotland (UK)
Sep 2025 - current

Current working research: "*Is Biodiversity risk priced in mutual fund returns*" - Supervisor: Dr. Maria Chiara Innanio, Prof. Bert Scholtens, Dr. Kulnicha Meechaiyo.

Master's in Finance, Corvinus University of Budapest, Budapest, Hungary
Sep 2023 – July 2025, GPA: 4.64/5

Thesis: "*Accessing Biodiversity risk impact on firm performance*" – Supervisor: Dr. Naffa Helena

Bachelor of Arts in Corporate Finance, National Economics University, Hanoi, Vietnam
Sep 2018 – July 2022, GPA: 3.52/4
Research projects:

"*Opportunities and Challenges of Vietnam in Agricultural exports through E-commerce*" – 2019

"Impact of entrepreneurship education on the intentions of startup for Economical students in Ha Noi" – 2020

"*Factors affecting professional audit judgments*" - 2021

Publications

Nguyen, Q. M., & Li, X. (2026). Assessing the impact of biodiversity risk exposure on performance of U.S. listed firms. *Journal of Economic and Banking Studies*, 6(1), 101-118. https://doi.org/10.59276/JEBS.2026.06.2714

Research Profile

- **Research Framework:** Investigating the transmission of nature-related risks into asset prices and collective investment vehicles. Current work analyzes the pricing of biodiversity risk premiums in global mutual fund returns and corporate performance using a double-materiality framework.
- **Econometrics & Modeling:** Cross-sectional asset pricing (Fama-MacBeth), portfolio sorting, asset-pricing factor frameworks (Fama-French 5-Factor + Momentum), high-dimensional panel data estimation.
- **Machine Learning & Data Science:** LassoNet, Random Forests, HistGradientBoostingRegressor, web scraping automation, structured financial data processing.

- **Textual Analysis & AI Tools:** Advanced text-mining of corporate financial reports (10-K, ESG disclosures). Native configuration of secure local LLM environments (Ollama with DeepSeek-R1 and Qwen) for scalable document classification.
- **Software Stack:** Python, R, Stata, VBA, SQL, LaTeX, AI prompting.
- **Databases:** LSEG Workspace / Refinitiv, Bloomberg Professional,SP Capital.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of St. Andrews Business School, Scotland (UK).
Sep 2025 - September 2027

- **Project:** *Double-Materiality Stress-Testing of Biodiversity Risk in Global Mutual-Fund Portfolios* (Funded by the Externality Investment Research Network; Grant Value: £32,680.66).
- **Key Responsibilities:** Formulated empirical asset-pricing frameworks to quantify double-materiality metrics across global mutual fund allocations. Programmed automated data extraction scripts to pipeline fund holdings data with asset-level environmental stress vectors. Collaborated closely with supervisors to translate empirical stress tests into policy working papers.

Research Assistant, **Sustainable Finance Research Centre,** Institutes of Finance, Corvinus University of Budapest, Hungary.
Mar 2024 - Jul 2025

- Conducting research on biodiversity finance, ESG metrics, and sustainability's impact on financial systems.
- Analyzing biodiversity-related financial data using tools such as R and Stata to identify the economic implications of sustainability practices.
- Assisted in the IUU Fishing Data Analysis Project, focusing on illegal, unreported, and unregulated fishing. Contributed by collecting and organizing data on maritime biodiversity impacts and collaborating on the development of suitable methodologies for economic evaluation.
- Preparing working papers and academic presentations on biodiversity risks, including their financial implications for industries reliant on natural resources.
- Collaborating with faculty to support grant proposals and academic publications aimed at advancing research in sustainable finance.

Teaching Experience

IELTS Instructor, IELTS exam preparation Course, RES, Ha Noi, Viet Nam,
2023

- Taught a class of 50 high school students in IELTS preparation, focusing on critical language skills: Reading, Writing, Listening, and Speaking.
- Developed and implemented lesson plans tailored to students' proficiency levels and academic goals.
- Utilized interactive teaching methods to enhance student engagement and improved IELTS scores, achieving a high success rate for university admission.

Awards / Distinctions

- **PhD Student-Led Scholarship:** Full tuition waiver and living stipend, University of St. Andrews (2025–2029).
- **Third Prize Individual TDK Award:** Student Scientific Research Competition, Corvinus University of Budapest (2024).
- **Stipendium Hungaricum Scholarship:** Full state-funded Master's fellowship, Government of Hungary (2023–2025).
- **3 University Annual Scientific Research Awards:** National Economics University, Vietnam (2020).
- **International Executive MBA Program Scholarship:** Paris Graduate School of Management (2022).

Working Paper: "Is Biodiversity Risk Priced in Mutual Funds?"

This paper investigates whether the firm-level biodiversity risk premium is transmitted into mutual fund returns, or if aggregation, diversification, and fund fees dilute the risk signal. Building on the equilibrium framework of Pástor et al. (2021), we analyze an unbalanced panel of 10,366 active equity mutual funds from December 2006 to February 2025 using LSEG data. Fund-level biodiversity exposure is captured via a novel "BioScore" that maps industry-specific nature dependencies (ENCORE) against regional ecological fragility (WRI Aqueduct) under a double-materiality framework. Using decile portfolio sorts and Fama-MacBeth cross-sectional regressions, we find that the biodiversity risk premium is highly dependent on the regional regulatory environment. In Europe, where coordinated frameworks (GBF, SFDR) provide clear pricing signals, high-biodiversity-risk funds generate significant risk-adjusted returns to compensate investors for nature-negative exposure. Conversely, in the United States, where environmental regulation remains fragmented, the premium is not statistically significant. This study provides the first empirical evidence of how biodiversity risk survives mutual fund aggregation, offering critical insights for fiduciaries, asset managers, and regulators navigating nature-related financial disclosures.

Industry experiences

Financial Analyst
VPS Group, Hanoi, Vietnam
May 2022 – Aug 2022

- Analyzed financial statements of subsidiaries to support the **Initial Public Offering (IPO)** process.
- Collaborated with securities firms to negotiate terms, reducing associated costs by 10%.
- Prepared comprehensive reports and presentations to assist the finance department in IPO planning.

Corporate Customer Relationship Intern
VietinBank, Hanoi, Vietnam
Jan 2022 – Apr 2022

- Analyze corporate clients' financial statements, loan applications, and underwritings documents to provide tailored banking solutions.
- Strengthened client relationships by offering personalized recommendations on banking products and services, aligning with their financial needs and objectives.
- Prepared and submitted detailed financial performance reports and compliance data to headquarters, ensuring accuracy and adherence to regulatory standards.
- Developed foundational sales skills by identifying client opportunities and promoting relevant financial products, contributing to revenue growth.

References

Dr. Maria Chiara Iannino Senior Lecturer in Finance, University of St. Andrews Business School Email: mci@st-andrews.ac.uk
Prof. Bert Scholtens Professor of Sustainable Finance, University of St. Andrews Business School Email: ljrs@st-andrews.ac.uk
Dr. Kulnicha Meechaiyo Lecturer in Finance, University of St. Andrews Business School Email: km364@st-andrews.ac.uk